

CHAPTER-2

BELIEFS AND WORSHIPS

Introduction

The two essential teachings of Islam, beliefs and worship, are discussed in this chapter. Beliefs and worships have a great significance in Islam. After *Tawheed*, belief in the Prophets is the fundamental Islamic belief. No one can be a Muslim without believing in all the Prophets without distinction. The concept of worship has also been explained in Islam. Prayer, Fasting, Pilgrimage and Zakat are the basic worships in Islam. Here, we will also discuss the importance of *Dua* (prayer) and the social benefits of Zakat.

Dua and Zakat are the two meaningful worships in Islam. *Dua* is not only the best expression of one's humbleness but also shows a great bonding with Almighty Allah. On the other hand, Zakat is the financial worship which develops economic prosperity in society. Moreover, it is also a source of gratitude towards Allah Almighty for the bounty of wealth.

Objectives

The importance of belief in the Prophets, the second Islamic belief, will be explained to the students by the end of this chapter. Students will have firm faith in this belief. They will develop a desire to follow the footsteps of the Prophets and a feeling of love and reverence towards them. The concept of *Dua* will be explained, and students will also realize the importance of Zakat and its social benefits.

(A)-Beliefs

Belief in the Prophets, Prophethood and its Requisites

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Describe the word '*Risalat*' literally and technically, along with its importance.
- Write four types of responsibilities towards Prophethood.
- Spend their lives according to the belief in Prophethood

Definition of *Risaalat*:

The literal meaning of '*Risaalat*' in Arabic is to convey a message, and '*Rasool*' means the one who conveys the message. Another word, '*Nabi*', is also used for '*Rasool*', which means the one who gives news or informs. In Islamic terminology, '*Rasool*' or '*Nabi*' is the chosen one whom Allah Almighty sends with His Message for the guidance of humanity.

Belief in Prophethood:

Allah Almighty created us for His worship. However, questions like how we should worship and what is the right way to spend our life cannot be answered by our choice and reasoning. Therefore, our Lord has sent His chosen servants as Messengers for our guidance. Allah Almighty says in the Holy Qur'an:

وَأَنْ مِنْ أُمَّةٍ إِلَّا خَلَا فِيهَا نَذِيرٌ

Translation: 'There is no community that has not had a warner.'
(Al-Fatir: 24)

In another place, Allah Almighty said:

وَلِكُلِّ أُمَّةٍ رَسُولٌ

Translation: 'And for every community, there is a messenger.'
(Yunus: 47)

Holy Qur'an mentions a few Prophets and Messengers. Nevertheless, the verses mentioned above describe that Allah Almighty has sent many Prophets and Messengers to different nations and regions. According to one narration, Allah Almighty has sent about 124,000 prophets, and it is mandatory to believe in all of them. According to the Islamic teachings, to deny any one of the prophets is to deny all of them because all were sent by Allah Almighty.

Prophet Adam عليه السلام was sent as the first, and حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ was sent as the Last Messenger. The chain of Prophethood and apostleship has ended with The Holy ﷺ forever because he is sent for the whole world till the Day of *Qiyamah*. This belief is called 'Belief in the finality of Prophethood' in Islam.

Wisdom for sending Prophets:

Allah Almighty loves His creation. Therefore, He sent His Messengers for the guidance of humankind so that they may live their lives following His Commandments and avoid His displeasure. Another reason for sending Messengers is that the man could not present any such excuse before Allah Almighty on the Day of *Qiyamah* that he did not know the reality of right and wrong, truth and falsehood.

Requisites of the belief in Prophethood:

Following are some obligations that are enjoined upon all Muslims concerning the belief in Prophets:

1. Love for the حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
2. The first and foremost requisite of belief in Prophethood is to express utmost love towards the Holy حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. As he is the one who taught man the real purpose of life and guided him to eternal success. It is narrated in a tradition that the Holy Prophet ﷺ said:
Translation: 'None of you have complete faith until I become more beloved to him than his father, his children, and all of the people.' (Sahih Bukhari & Sahih Muslim)
3. If the love is true with the Holy حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, it will be easy to follow him. Otherwise, it will not be easy.
4. Respect and Reverence: The second requisite of belief in Prophethood is to respect them with heart and soul. Allah Almighty said in the Holy Quran:

لِتُؤْمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ وَتُعَزِّرُوهُ وَتُوَقِّرُوهُ

Translation: 'So that you 'believers' may have faith in Allah and His Messenger, support and honour him.' (Al-Fath: 9)

In the light of Surah Hujraat, it is proved that any slightest blasphemy of the Holy Prophet ﷺ displeases Almighty Allah and ruins all the good deeds of a man. Hence, to say or write any word of disrespect or draw his picture is against his love and reverence.

5. Help and Support: The third requisite of belief in Prophethood is to support him in his holy mission. The believer must follow his message in the propagation of Islam, preaching and raising the Word of Allah Almighty, as practised by the Companions رضى الله عنهم. Likewise, it is our duty in today's life to spread his message in the world and spend our time and wealth with sincerity.
6. Obedience: The fourth significant requisite of belief in Prophethood is to make them role models. As Allah Almighty said:

وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ رَّسُولٍ إِلَّا لِيُطَاعَ بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ

Translation: 'We only sent messengers to be obeyed by Allah's Will.'
(Al-Nisa: 64)

We must practise wholeheartedly whatever the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ taught us. Obedience to the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ is meant to follow his given principles in all walks of life, such as beliefs, worship, lawful & unlawful, permissible & impermissible, pure & impure, economics & politics, justice & fairness. After the obedience to Allah Almighty, the obedience of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ is supreme.

Summary of the Lesson

- Allah Almighty loves human beings. He did not leave humans without guidance. He sent prophets for their guidance so they may get His pleasure and live their lives according to His commandments.
- Allah Almighty has sent the prophets and Messengers to every nation and region.
- The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ was sent as the Last Messenger to the whole universe. Prophethood and Apostleship have been ended on him.

It teaches us that the belief in Prophethood should be inculcated in our minds. We should fulfill its requisitions with our actions.

Activity for the students

Students should learn the names of all the prophets mentioned in the Holy Quran.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. Explain the meaning and concept of Prophethood and Apostleship.
2. What is the Finality of Prophethood? Describe its importance.
3. What is meant by the blasphemy of the Holy Prophet ﷺ?
4. What are the requisitions of the Prophethood?
5. Narrate any verse related to Prophethood.

2. Fill in the blanks:

1. After Allah Almighty, obedience to _____ is paramount.
2. _____ of the Holy Prophet ﷺ ruins all the good deeds.
3. The chain of _____ has been ended forever upon the Holy Prophet ﷺ.
4. _____ was sent to every nation.
5. The Holy Qur'an mentions only _____ Prophets and Messengers.

3. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. The requisite of belief in Prophethood is to respect him wholeheartedly.	☐	☐
2. Allah Almighty has sent the prophets only to Arabs.	☐	☐
3. There are 100 prophets mentioned in the Holy Qur'an.	☐	☐
4. Allah Almighty has created us only for eating and drinking.	☐	☐
5. 'Rasool' means the one who conveys the message.	☐	☐
6. The Holy Prophet ﷺ was sent as the Last Messenger for the whole universe.	☐	☐

4. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
1. Hazrat Adam عليه السلام was	was sent as the Last Messenger.
2. The second requisite of belief in the Prophethood is	is to make them Role Models.
3. The Holy Prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم	it will be easy to follow him.
4. If the love for the حضرت محمد رسول الله ﷺ حاتم النبيين صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم is true,	sent as the first Prophet.
5. The fourth requisite of belief in Prophets	to respect him with heart and soul.



Have a debate on the topic 'Requisites of Prophethood' among students.

(B)-Worships

The Concept of Worship in Islam

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Describe the meaning and concept of worship
- Write down the Islamic concept of worship-
- Describe that the actual concept of worship will develop unity in their social life and remove practical chaos.
- Spend their lives following the rules of worship

Definition of Worship:

Worship literally means to serve or to enslave; in Islamic terminology, it means to serve one's true Creator and Master, Allah Almighty. A man who serves or enslaves is called *Abd*— a slave. As a slave serves and obeys his master, similarly a true *Abd* – slave serves and obeys his Master Allah Almighty.



According to the Holy Qur'an, Allah Almighty has created human beings only for His worship. As Allah said:

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ

Translation: 'I did not create jinn and humans except to worship Me.'
(Al-Zariyat: 56)

The Comprehensive Concept of Worship in Islam:

The Concept of Worship in Islam is very broad and comprehensive. According to Islamic teachings, our worship benefits us only and not our Lord. Even if all the people of the world turn away from the worship of Allah Almighty, there can never be a reduction in His power and authority. Similarly, if all the people of the world start worshipping Him, it cannot cause an increase in His infinite power and great authority. In Islam, the concept of worship is not confined to prayer, fasting, Hajj and remembrance of Allah Almighty, but all the matters of life and deeds that are done in accordance with the commands of Allah Almighty are also included in worship. If a person runs a business or trade and obeys Allah and His Messenger ﷺ, he is actually worshipping. That is why it is said that obtaining lawful sustenance is an exact worship.

In the same way, if an employee, whether public or private, is doing his duty with due persistence and honesty, he is engaged in worship. Thus, if a person is studying hard and diligently to serve his country and nation, he is actually worshipping. Hence, it is clear that if the teachings of Allah Almighty and His ﷺ are not violated in any matter of life, it can rightly be called 'Ibaadat'.

With this concept of worship, the rights of Allah and human rights are fulfilled, which develops a good society. Evils are eradicated from society, and good human morals and attributes are developed. Evils like lies, dishonesty, murder, oppression and injustice are eradicated. The era of the Holy Prophet ﷺ and his Companions is a clear historical proof of this. The concept of worship is generally considered to be very limited. We only consider prayer, fasting, zakat, Hajj and remembrance as worship and ignore matters from worships.

Summary of the Lesson

- Worship is called servitude and slavery. Further, the concept of worship in Islam is very broad and comprehensive. Doing all the affairs of one's life according to the teachings of Allah Almighty and His ﷺ is worship. Prayer, Fasting, Zakat and Hajj also prepare man for this.

From this, we learned that we should consider all matters of life as worship and perform them according to the teachings of Allah Almighty and His ﷺ.

Activity for the students

Students should write a brief account on 'Worship' in their notebooks and submit it to their teachers.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is the literal meaning of 'Ibaadat'?
2. What is the concept of worship in Islam?
3. What is the purpose of human creation?
4. Who gets the benefits of our worship?

2. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. The literal meaning of 'Ibaadat' is:

(A) To offer prayer	(B) To observe fast
(C) To serve or enslave	(D) To perform Hajj
2. According to Islamic teachings, our worship:

(A) Gives benefits tous	(B) Does not benefit us
(C) Benefits others	(D) Benefits no one
3. Obtaining lawful sustenance is:

(A) Exact service	(B) Exact worship
(C) Exact humanity	(D) Exact trust
4. In any matter of life, if the teachings of Allah Almighty and His ﷺ are not violated then:

(A) It is called sincerity	(B) It is called trust
(C) It is called truthfulness	(D) It is called worship
5. The person who performs slavery or servitude, he is called

(A) Intelligent	(B) Abd
(C) Beloved	(D) Masroor

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. Obtaining lawful sustenance is exact _____.
2. The concept of _____ in Islam is very broad.
3. Ibaadat means _____.
4. We only consider _____ as worship.
5. Allah Almighty created _____ and man only for His worship.

4. Tick ✓ the right answers and cross ✗ the wrong answers:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. The concept of worship in Islam is confined.	☐	☐
2. 'Ibaadat' means to serve.	☐	☐
3. Running a business in accordance with the teachings of Allah Almighty and His ﷺ is an Ibaadat.	☐	☐
4. Obtaining education to serve the country and nation is an Ibaadat.	☐	☐
5. Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه replied to a Jew that our worship is confined.	☐	☐

5. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
The concept of worship in Islam	to serve or enslave.
The meaning of worship is	is considered very confined.
Today the concept of our worship	is very broad and comprehensive.
We only consider Prayer, Fast	they should worship only Allah.
Man and Jinn are created so that	Zakat, Hajj and Remembrance as worship.



Have a debate on the benefits of the Islamic concept of worship.

2. The Importance and Benefits of *Dua* (Supplication)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Describe the meaning and concept of *Dua*
- Write down the importance and significance of *Dua*.
- Describe the wisdom and benefits of *Dua*.
- Supplicate in daily life according to its etiquettes

Definition of *Dua*:

‘Dua’ is an Arabic word that means to call upon or invoke. In *Dua*, a person calls or invokes Allah Almighty with his tongue or heart; therefore, it is called ‘Dua’. According to the teachings of Islam, *Dua* is an act of pure worship. Therefore, it can be sought only from Allah Almighty alone. No one should be associated with Allah Almighty in this act. Allah Almighty said:

ادْعُونِي أَسْتَجِبْ لَكُمْ

Translation: ‘Call upon Me, I will accept’. (Al-Momin: 60)



Importance and Benefits of *Dua*:

There come many occasions in a person's daily life when he finds himself compelled and helpless. When all the material supports and worldly means fail, the man cries out from the heart and turns to the One Who created this universe with utmost perfection. He is the One Who has perfect power over everything. He is Allah Almighty. Man, having firm faith in Him, when calls on Him with his heart or with his tongue, He listens to him and fulfills his need. He is the All-Hearing and the All-Seeing. There is no limitation for Him. As Allah Almighty said:

وَإِذَا سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِي عَنِّي فَإِنِّي قَرِيبٌ أُجِيبُ دَعْوَةَ الدَّاعِ إِذَا دَعَانِ فَلْيَسْتَجِيبُوا لِي وَلْيُؤْمِنُوا بِلَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْشُدُونَ

‘When My servants ask you ‘O Prophet about Me, then I am truly near. I answer the one’s prayer when he calls upon Me. So let them respond with obedience to Me and believe in Me, so that they may attain guidance (to the Right Way).’

Regarding the importance of *Dua*, the Holy Prophet ﷺ said:

الدُّعَاءُ مِنْ الْعِبَادَةِ

Translation: 'Prayer (Dua) is the core of worship.'

All Prophets used to invoke Allah Almighty in every situation. They gave the same guidance to other human beings as well. Whenever a Muslim prays to Allah Almighty with full faith and certainty, that *Dua* is accepted.

According to a tradition, there are three forms of acceptance of *Dua*: It is accepted in this world, or it will be rewarded in the Hereafter, or any future trouble is removed from the person.

Here are some favourite prayers of the Holy Prophet ﷺ.

رَبَّنَا آتِنَا فِي الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةً وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ حَسَنَةً وَقِنَا عَذَابَ النَّارِ

Translation: 'Our Lord! Grant us the good of this world and the good of Hereafter, and protect us from the punishment of the Fire.' (Al-Baqarah: 201)

رَبِّ زِدْنِي عِلْمًا

Translation: 'My Lord! Bestow me more knowledge'. (Taha: 114)

The Wisdom of Dua:

In the difficulties, sufferings and calamities of the world, man becomes helpless and frustrated. The wisdom of *Dua* in such a situation is that it encourages man, saves him from frustration, and connects him with Allah Almighty.

Manners of Dua:

Following are some manners for the acceptance of *Dua*:

- To make *Dua* with sincerity and concentration.
- To eat *Halal* (Lawful provisions).
- Do not pray for evil and sinful deeds.
- To only ask from Allah Almighty.
- To pray with confidence and certainty of acceptance.

Benefits of Dua:

- *Dua* is the most effective weapon for relieving anxiety.
- *Dua* is the source of salvation and healing from diseases.
- *Dua* strengthens the relationship with Allah Almighty.
- *Dua* strengthens willpower.
- *Dua* increases the state of belief in the heart and mind.
- *Dua* increases trust in the power of Allah Almighty.
- *Dua* carries out with humility. Raising hands, imploring, and confessing guilt eliminate the feelings of arrogance and rebellion. As a result, all actions and deeds are moulded into humbleness and humility.

Summary of the Lesson

- *Dua* is an essential act of worship. *Dua* is the spirit of worship.
- *Dua* exhibits the humility of man.
- *Dua* is a valuable support for the man in difficulties.
- *Dua* should only be made to Allah Almighty.
- Every Prophet prayed to Allah Almighty and advised his nation to pray to Allah Almighty alone.

Activity for the students

Write down the translation of the favourite *Dua*'as (prayers) of the Holy Prophet ﷺ with good handwriting in notebooks.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. From which language the word *Dua* is derived, and what is its meaning?
2. Why is *Dua* made?
3. What are the manners for the acceptance of *Dua*?
4. To whom is *Dua* made?
5. Describe the importance of *Dua*.

2. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. The literal meaning of *Dua* is:
(A) To read (B) To give
(C) To call upon (D) To get better
2. The favourite *Dua* of the Holy Prophet ﷺ mentioned in the lesson is:
(A) About the Forgiveness of parents (B) About Health
(C) About Knowledge (D) About Children
3. The conditions for the acceptance of *Dua* are:
(A) Two (B) Three
(C) Four (D) Five
4. The wisdom of *Dua* for a person is that it:
(A) gives him encouragement (B) makes him wealthy only
(C) becomes a source of parental consent for him (D) only develops love in him

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. *Dua* is an important _____.
2. All Prophets used to _____ Him in all circumstances.
3. Allah Almighty said: '_____ Me, I will accept.'
4. *Dua* is a valuable _____ for man in difficulties.

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. The word <i>Dua</i> means to call upon or to invoke.	☐	☐
2. We should only make <i>Dua</i> to Allah Almighty.	☐	☐
3. There are two conditions for the acceptance of <i>Dua</i> .	☐	☐
4. <i>Dua</i> shows arrogance.	☐	☐

5. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
The word 'Dua'	is a pure act of worship.
According to Islamic teachings, <i>Dua</i>	call upon Allah Almighty.
All Prophets used to	(Arabic Text)
The favourite <i>Dua</i> of the Holy Prophet ﷺ is	is an Arabic Word.



**Instruction
for the
teachers**

Students should learn the *Dua* nicely which is given in the lesson.

3-Zakat (Obligatory alms giving)

(Virtue and Social Significance)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Learn the meaning and concept of Zakat
- Explain the virtues and recipients of Zakat and motivate others
- Describe the social significance of this great financial worship of Islam
- Pay Zakat, when they grow up and get obliged

Definition of Zakat:

The literal meaning of the Arabic word 'Zakat' is purification and growth. In Islamic teachings, Zakat means spending a specific amount of wealth in the way of Allah Almighty at the prescribed rate. By paying Zakat, wealth becomes purified, and blessings are obtained in the world and hereafter. That is why it is called 'Zakat'.

Virtues of Zakat:

Zakat is a fundamental pillar of Islam. As Prayer is the most virtuous act in physical worship, so is Zakat in financial worship. Prayer is at the top of the list in *Huqooq ul Allah* (Rights of Allah). Similarly, Zakat is at the top of the list in *Huqooq ul I'baad* (Human Rights). In many places of the Holy Quran, Zakat is mentioned along with Prayer and sometimes separately. Commanding about Zakat, Allah Almighty said:

خُذْ مِنْ أَمْوَالِهِمْ صَدَقَةً تُطَهِّرُهُمْ وَتُزَكِّيهِمْ بِهَا

Translation: 'Take from their wealth 'O Prophet' charity to purify and bless them'. (Al-Tawbah: 103)

In another place, it is said about the blessings of Zakat in wealth:

Translation: 'The example of those who spend their wealth in the cause of Allah is that of a grain that sprouts into seven ears, each bearing one hundred grains. And Allah multiplies the reward even more to whoever He wills. For Allah is All-Bountiful, All-Knowing.' (Al-Baqarah: 261)

In 9 A.H, when the Holy Prophet ﷺ sent Hazrat Ma'az bin Jabal رضي الله عنه as a preacher of Islam to Yemen, among the fundamental teachings of Islam, he mentioned this also:

'Tell them that Allah Almighty has enjoined Zakat on their wealth which will be taken from their rich men and given to their poor.'

Zakat is obligatory on every Muslim man and woman who, in addition to their basic needs, have a rate of seven and a half Tola of gold (87.48 gm) or fifty-two and a half Tola of silver (612.36 gm), or wealth to its equivalent, or commercial goods and this remains in his possession for one year. Zakat is obligatory on him/her at the rate of two and a half percent (2.5%).

Recipients of Zakat:

Zakat can only be distributed among the following eight people. As Allah Almighty said:

إِنَّمَا الصَّدَقَتُ لِلْفُقَرَاءِ وَالْمَسْكِينِ وَالْعَبْدِيِّنَ عَلَيْهَا وَالْمَوْلَقَةِ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَفِي الرِّقَابِ وَالْغَرَمِينَ وَفِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَابْنِ السَّبِيلِ فَرِيضَةً مِّنَ اللَّهِ وَاللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ

Translation: ‘Zakat is only for the poor and the needy, for those employed to administer it, for those whose hearts are attracted to the faith, for freeing slaves, for those in debt, for Allah’s cause, and for needy travellers. This is an obligation from Allah. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.’ (Al-Tawbah: 60)

Social Importance of Zakat:

Zakat is the social order of Islam. If it is not paid, the government can take legal action against it. A study of Islamic history reveals that when Hazrat Abu Bakr Siddiq رضى الله عنه was elected as the caliph, some people refused to pay Zakat. Hence, after consultation with the companions, he declared Jihad against them until they agreed to pay Zakat. His historical words are:

“By Allah! I will definitely fight those who differentiate between Prayer and Zakat. Zakat is the right of wealth! By Allah, if they do not give me a baby goat that they used to give to the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ, then I will definitely fight against them.”

Benefits of Paying Zakat:

According to Islamic law, if the system of Zakat is appropriately followed, poverty can be eradicated from society. As a result, the country and the nation will develop. In addition, society can eliminate destructive moral diseases such as miserliness, greed and selfishness. Thus, peace, tranquillity, mutual brotherhood, and love will flourish in society.

During the time of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and his companions, when the system of Zakat was formally implemented, prosperity became common in the Islamic Empire in just a few years. Likewise, if the system of Zakat is strictly followed in our homeland Pakistan, poverty will be eradicated from our homeland within a short time, and we will be on the path to development and progress.

Disadvantages of Not Paying Zakat:

The Holy Qur'an warns those who do not pay Zakat:

وَالَّذِينَ يَكْنِزُونَ الذَّهَبَ وَالْفِضَّةَ وَلَا يَنْفِقُونَهَا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَبَشِّرْهُمْ بِعَذَابٍ أَلِيمٍ ۝ يَوْمَ يُخْلِى عَنْهَا فِي نَارٍ
جَهَنَّمَ فَتُكْوَى بِهَا جِبَاهُهُمْ وَجُنُوبُهُمْ وَظُهُورُهُمْ هَذَا مَا كَنْزْتُمْ لَكُمْ أَنْفُسَكُمْ فَذُوقُوا مَا كَنْزْتُمْ تَكْنِزُونَ ۝

Translation: 'Give good news of a painful torment to those who hoard gold and silver and do not spend it in Allah's cause. The Day will come when their treasure will be heated up in the Fire of Hell, and their foreheads, sides, and backs branded with it. It will be said to them: 'This is the treasure you hoarded for yourselves. Now taste what you hoarded!' (Al-Tawba: 34-35)

Besides, there are many other worldly disadvantages of not paying Zakat. Some of them are as follows:

- The Islamic government can take legal action against those who do not pay zakat.
- Wealth becomes limited to a few hands only and does not circulates if Zakat is not paid.
- Not paying Zakat develops class conflict.
- It also removes the blessing of wealth.

Summary of the Lesson

- Zakat is an essential act of financial worship in Islam. It is at the top of the list in *Huqooq ul Ibad* (Human Rights).
- Zakat is obligatory only on rich people.
- The Holy Quran and Hadith strictly emphasized on the payment of Zakat. The government can take legal action against those who do not pay zakat. Moreover, severe torment will be inflicted in the Hereafter.
- Implementing the system of Zakat eliminates poverty from society and eradicates moral diseases like miserliness and greed. Consequently, an environment of compassion and brotherhood grows.

We have learned a lesson that we should seek the pleasure of Allah Almighty by paying Zakat and trying to fulfill the needs of the poor people in society. In this way, society will be free from miserliness, greed and selfishness.

Activity for the students

Students should write down the Quranic Verse related to the Recipients of Zakat with translation in good handwriting.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is the literal meaning of Zakat?
2. What is the meaning of Zakat in Islamic terminology?
3. How many recipients of Zakat are there? State any three of them.
4. Describe the rate of Zakat.
5. Discuss any two social benefits of Zakat.

2. Fill in the blanks:

1. _____ is the most virtuous act of financial worships.
2. Legal action can be taken by _____ against those who do not pay Zakat.
3. Non-payment of Zakat develops _____ conflict.
4. By implementing the system of Zakat, moral diseases like miserliness and _____ can be removed.
5. Implementing Zakat system will lead our country to _____.

3. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. The rate of Zakat is 10 Tola of gold.	☐	☐
2. Zakat is obligatory only on Muslims.	☐	☐
3. Zakat is at the top of the list in <i>Huqooq ul Allah</i> (Rights of Allah).	☐	☐
4. Implementing Zakat system can remove poverty from society.	☐	☐
5. Zakat can be given to five recipients.	☐	☐

4. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
I will definitely fight against those	prosperity became common in just a few years.
When the system of Zakat was formally implemented	in <i>Huqooq ul Ibad</i> (Human Rights).
Zakat is at the top of the list	who make a distinction between Prayer and Zakat.
Zakat is for the poor and the needy	Poverty can be removed.
If Zakat is implemented,	and for those employed to administer Zakat.



Instruction for the teachers

Arrange a debate among students on the advantages of paying Zakat and the disadvantages of not paying Zakat.